

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	28 June 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Comprehensive Analysis and Dietary Strategies with Tableau: A College Food Choices Case Study
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

Brainstorming provides a free and open environment that encourages everyone within a team to participate in the creative thinking process that leads to problem solving. Prioritizing volume over value, out-of-the-box ideas are welcome and built upon, and all participants are encouraged to collaborate, helping each other develop a rich amount of creative solutions.

Use this template in your own brainstorming sessions so your team can unleash their imagination and start shaping concepts even if you're not sitting in the same room.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

1

Define your problem statement
What problem are you trying to solve? Frame your problem as a How Might We statement. This will be the focus of your brainstorm.
⌚ 5 minutes

How might we turn raw college eating survey data into interactive Tableau dashboards so that busy students can optimize their academic concentration, and campus cafeteria managers can confidently introduce healthy menu adjustments without financial risk?

Key rules of brainstorming
To run a smooth and productive session

Stay in topic

Defier judgment

Go for volume

Encourage wild ideas

Listen to others

If possible, be visual

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2

Brainstorm
Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.
⌚ 10 minutes

TIP

How can you select a sticky note and not the pencil (and/or the sheet) to stick it on?

Person 1

Person 1
(Student Behavior Focus)

Track breakfast habit frequency against overall student GPA averages to check for direct academic impacts.

Evaluate how tracking nutritional value (nutritional_check) impacts how energetic a student feels (healthy_feeling).

Person 2

Person 2
(Emotional & Stress Eating Focus)

Analyze the categorical reasons column comfort_food_reasons_coded to map out primary emotional triggers.

Build a parsing mechanism to extract specific snacks from the unstructured text lists in comfort_food

Person 3

Person 3
(Cafeteria Strategy Focus)

- Compare individual daily baseline portions of fresh food (fruit_day & veggies_day) against dining out frequencies (eating_out).

Aggregate data fields from cultural categories (ethnic_food, italian_food, thai_food, indian_food) to identify preferred cuisine models.

3

Group Ideas
Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. Once all sticky notes have been grouped, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you can break it up into smaller sub-groups.
⌚ 20 minutes

TIP

Ask student/partner tips to allow notes to make it easier to find, browse, organize, and categorize important ideas as themes within your mind.

- 📁 Theme A: Academic Focus & Awareness Metrics (Rahul's View)
 - Includes Notes 1 & 2
 - **Goal:** Build dashboard visual components explicitly showcasing calorie awareness and meal patterns to help students eliminate late-night junk food dependencies and stabilize energy levels.
- 📁 Theme B: Emotional Analytics & Habit Management (Priya's View)
 - Includes Notes 3 & 4
 - **Goal:** Surface stress and boredom trends so students can visually recognize emotional eating patterns during high-intensity exam periods and choose healthier macro substitutes.
- 📁 Theme C: Institutional Dining Strategy (Cafeteria Manager's View)
 - Includes Notes 5 & 6
 - **Goal:** Map general menu preferences and low fruits/veggies consumption into a structured layout that safely justifies introducing high-demand salad bars or healthy combos.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

4

Prioritize

Your team should all be on the same page about what's important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.

20 minutes

TIP

Participants can use their own sticky notes to place ideas on the grid. The facilitator can define the grid by using the four corners, dividing the page on the right side.

